TIMO PAUEN

Ph.D. Candidate, University of Cologne
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Cost of Capital and Valuation · Belief Formation under Uncertainty · Earnings Forecasts · Measurement-Error Econometrics · Bayesian Methods · Disclosure and Unstructured Data

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Accounting, University of Cologne 2021–2027 (expected)
Dissertation: *"Belief Formation and the Cost of Capital"*
Expected completion: first half of 2027
Committee: Prof. Carsten Homburg (Chair), Prof. Michael Overesch, Prof. Maximilian A. Müller

M.Sc. in Economics – Cum Laude, Radboud University, Nijmegen 2020–2021
Focus: Financial Economics
Thesis: *"What Induces Changes in Beliefs? And to What Extent Are Beliefs and Actions Aligned? An Out-of-Sample Test with Professionals and Students."*

B.Sc. in Economics, University of Cologne 2012–2015
Thesis: *"How much Money is Hidden in Tax Havens?"*

RESEARCH PAPERS

Pauen, T. *Cost of Capital: A Bayesian Approach.* Working Paper, University of Cologne. *(Job Market Paper)*
Bayesian model of investors' earnings expectations that filters noisy analyst forecasts toward a fundamental prior; the implied cost-of-capital estimates predict realized returns more reliably than analyst-based estimates and are reliable in both cross-sectional and time-series designs.

Homburg, C., **Pauen, T.,** Rothe, L., & Schick, R. *A Meta-Method to Improve Implied Cost of Capital Metrics.* Working Paper, University of Cologne.
Shows that measurement error in implied cost-of-capital estimates is partly persistent and firm-specific, and controls for it to improve return prediction.

Pauen, T. *A New Measure of Earnings Forecast Uncertainty – Revisited.* Working Paper, University of Cologne.
Ex-ante Bayesian measure of the uncertainty common to all analysts; matches ex-post measures in revision-prediction tasks and covers substantially more firms than the GARCH-based alternative.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Pauen, T. *Certify First: Evaluating Expected-Return Proxies.*
Bootstrap certification procedure that tests whether competing expected-return proxies share a common normalized covariance pattern with future realized returns, pre-evaluating proxies before conventional evaluation.

Pauen, T. *Visual Presentation as a Dimension of Disclosure: A Machine-Readable Measure from 10-K Filings.*
Renders 10-K filings from SEC EDGAR into a machine-readable measure of visual disclosure density, distinct from readability, and links it to post-filing return volatility.

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Researcher 2021–present
Chair of Management Accounting (Prof. Carsten Homburg), University of Cologne
Sole- and co-authored empirical projects on expectations and the cost of capital; builds and maintains large-scale CRSP/I/B/E/S/Compustat data pipelines in R.

Student Research Assistant 2020–2021
Department of Economics, Radboud University
Designed new examination materials for the chair of Pluralism in Economics.

Referent (Controlling Analyst) 2017–2020
Internal Controlling, Santander Consumer Bank AG, Mönchengladbach
Built, supervised, and analyzed data from internal controlling tools feeding the bank's KPIs and recurring management-controlling reviews.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Scandinavian Accounting Research Conference, BI Norwegian Business School, Oslo 2026
"Cost of Capital: A Bayesian Approach."

Brown Bag Seminar, University of Cologne 2026
"Cost of Capital: A Bayesian Approach."

SKILLS

Programming & Computing: R (advanced; data.table, parallelized workflows on a 32-core workstation), MATLAB, LaTeX, Git.
Data: WRDS, Compustat, CRSP, I/B/E/S, SEC EDGAR (rendered filings).
Methods: panel and measurement-error econometrics, Bayesian and state-space estimation, bootstrap inference, machine learning, asset-pricing tests (Fama–MacBeth, factor models).
Languages: German (native), English (fluent).

TEACHING & SUPERVISION

University of Cologne 2021–present

– Cost Accounting (B.Sc.), ~300 students — selected lectures and exercise sessions.
– Value-Based Controlling (M.Sc.), ~60 students — co-taught; organized practitioner guest talks at the university and at partner firms.
– Master's seminar Research in Accounting — supervised seminar theses and presentations
– Thesis supervision: ~2 Master's and 3–4 Bachelor's theses per semester (30+ total).

Teaching interests: managerial accounting, financial statement analysis, valuation and value-based management, empirical research methods, and financial econometrics.

SERVICE

Chair of Management Accounting, University of Cologne 2021–present

– Coordinate the chair's thesis process: applications, point of contact for students, assignment of accepted theses.
– Organize the kick-off sessions of the mandatory Bachelor's and Master's seminars.
– Organize and host practitioner talks with invited firm representatives.
– Maintain the chair's course data in the university's student information system (KLIPS) and its website (TYPO3).
– Treasurer of the chair's research support association (Förderverein).

REFERENCES

Prof. Carsten Homburg — dissertation chair
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Prof. Maximilian A. Müller — dissertation committee
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